

The Story

How this project actually came to be, told as it happened — kept separate from procedures and instructions, so it stays readable instead of turning into a spec.

PART ONE

How It's Born

It didn't start as an app idea. It started as annoyance: having to remember (or look up) Git/GitHub terminal commands every time, when it's really just a handful of words you'd rather copy-paste than memorize. That need — a fast place to grab the command you needed — came first.

From there, the idea generalized: it's not just Git commands you want quick access to, it's any small thing — a code snippet, a hook, a helper you wrote once and now can't find. So the scope widened from "my Git cheat sheet" to "anywhere I stash reusable code" — which is where the name came from: **Codestash**.

The first real shape of it was small on purpose: a single self-contained HTML file, inline styles and JS, no build step — with an accordion so you could expand just the snippet you needed and ignore the rest. Fast, disposable, zero setup.

Today it's grown past that into an actual web app — Next.js, a real database, accounts, workspaces.

annoyance with Git commands → generalized into "a stash for any snippet" → a quick single-file HTML doc → a full web app

Where the Redesign Came From

It started as UI work — the sidebar category buttons needed drag-and-drop, and a scrollbar for when a category had too many sub-items to fit. Small, contained fixes.

But working through those UI questions kept surfacing something underneath: the problem wasn't really the buttons. Who could drag, who could invite, how many categories a workspace could have, what a "member" versus an "owner" was even allowed to do — none of that was actually decided anywhere. The UI kept asking questions the architecture didn't have answers for yet.

That's the moment it turned from "fix the sidebar" into "we need to redesign this." The goal for the redesign: good user experience, first and foremost — and getting there means going back and rethinking the architecture underneath it, not just patching the UI on top of what's already there.

More parts to come as the redesign itself takes shape — the actual architectural plan is its own conversation, not part of this story.